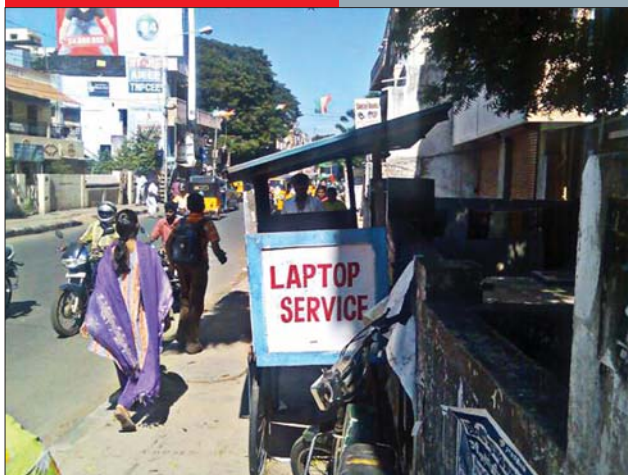


DigiPick of the month

Portable and affordable



Last month's winner:

V Balaji Sarvanan
Chennai

Participate and
win next month:

**Pro WPF
Windows
Presentation
Foundation
in .NET 3.0**

by Mathew MacDonald

Published by

 **WILEY-INDIA**



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with **"DigiPick"** in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

in happy cases, were instantly drawn to each other. Both happened to have been stuck in marriages that were on the rocks—no sex, no cooking for each other, no catering to each other's fantasies by wearing lacy bras—you get the idea. It's a heart-warming story: the two found each other funny, warm and sympathetic—qualities they could no longer spot in their spouses even after detailed gene mapping.

After quite some time chatting, S and P decided to take that orgasmic final online step—meet up in real life, braving the snipers and land-mines. (They both lived in Zenica, Bosnia.)

All good things, though, must come to an end. The rendezvous went according to plan, but things went downhill from here. Actually, "downhill" is the wrong word: things turned ugly. Why? Was Sweetie ugly? Was the self-proclaimed Prince no visual Joy? Well, it turned out they knew each other more than casually; they knew when the lacy bras had last been worn. They were husband and wife.

Since the online wannabe offlines had bonded based on mutual spouse-antipathy, what was supposed to have been a romantic date became traumatic hate: a shouting contest on the street. Even the sniper rifles couldn't be heard over them.

Our far-flung reporters tell us that last they heard, the couple had done the square thing and gone to the divorce courts.

On a rational level: if they'd seen personal qualities online they hadn't seen before, they could have kissed and made up (or out) right on the street, land-mines willing. But no-one with names like Sweetie (and Jack of Spades or whatever) can be expected to be rational... yes?

NAME GAME

Russian Roulette

A lot of things changed in 1991. Most notably, the unfortunately long experiment that was

the Soviet Union was finally put to rest. Godless communists suddenly ditched sickles for candles and vodka for wine. And die-hard comrades, the kind who would yell on the phone, "Petrova! P for Party!... No! R for Red!"—well, such-like folks the world over were heartbroken. They've been feeling lost ever since.

But, though the Internet is Godless, it's also the great uniter. And guess what: the Soviet Union is alive and kicking in cyberspace.

In the early days of the Internet and the last nights of the USSR, the ICANN—the US-based international body which looks after the giving of names to things on the WWW—assigned ".su" to the once-country. (Ha-ha! Bet you didn't know!) Fifteen months later, the Soviet Union was no longer on the map, but to this day, .su domains sit cheek by jowl with .ru crack sites. Yes! Check out www.internet.su! It works! (That it only says "test" in text is another matter.) And—mwahaha-hahahaha! There is a lenin.su! We just knew it! It

People Who Changed Computing

"The Computer Man"?

What did Alan Kay not do? He is best known for being one of the earliest architects of object-oriented programming (he coined the term) and for his contributions to the GUI. And also for "The best way to predict the future is to invent it"—yes, you've heard that; it was Kay who said it. Squeak.org says he developed the idea of personal computing; gatech.edu says he's considered by many to be the most influential computer scientist of the modern era.



Alan Kay

The man is overshadowed by his achievements; he seems to have done little but work, eminently productive work—but he also used to play jazz guitar, pro! Interesting how computers should lead a man away from guitaring...

Kay did almost too many things: part of the original team that developed continuous-tone 3D graphics. Co-designed the FLEX Machine, an early Desktop computer with a GUI and Object-Oriented OS. Participated in the design of the ARPANET. Conceived the Dynabook, a laptop for children; it is behind the basics of the laptop and tablet PC. Invented Smalltalk, the first completely object-oriented programming, authoring and operating system, which had the familiar window interface. Worked in screen painting and animation, and desktop publishing, and the development of the first modern networked PC.

Kay has been a Xerox Fellow, Chief Scientist of Atari, Apple Fellow, HP Senior Fellow... the list goes on! Well beyond a Person Who Changed Computing, he invented a lot of it...